



The Humanitas Institute

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Candeo Schools Peoria

School Website: <https://candeoschools.com/locations/candeo-peoria/>

December 27, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

Candeo Schools Peoria AZ 85383, based on the publicly accessible site content in the school's crawl and using the classical-education rubric from the knowledge base, does not clearly demonstrate the core features of a Classical School. The publicly visible elements are limited to standard school navigation items (e.g., About, Mission, Philosophy, Vision & Values, Curriculum & Instruction, Parents, etc.) with no explicit articulation of Great Books, the trivium/quadrivium, scholé (restful learning), liturgical/communal worship, or a theology-led curriculum. As such, across the six classical categories, the school shows little evidence of alignment with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) framework (e.g., Great Books, teleology, theology, memory and chant, Socratic pedagogy, etc.). The site does include a Parents section, but that alone does not suffice to position the school as Classical.

Key sources informing this assessment include the classical education rubric and lexicon (Six Essential Elements) and its associated keyword indicators (truth, virtue, Great Books, scholé, liturgy, theology, etc.), which anchor the evaluation criteria. The school's crawl content shows standard navigational items like About, Mission, Curriculum & Instruction, and Parents, but does not reveal the explicit classical elements that would justify a CLASSICAL or SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating. See the Six Essential Elements lexicon for the expected signals of a classical orientation, including Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, theology, scholé, and liturgical practices, as well as the explicit sections on Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Partnerships with Parents (which are often present in classical schools). The school's own materials reference Mission, Philosophy, Vision & Values and Curriculum & Instruction, but lack direct textual evidence of classical practices (e.g., Great Books, Socratic seminars, or liturgical communities) in the accessible crawl excerpt provided by the crawl data.

### Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

#### Evidence

- The crawl shows navigation elements like About; Our Story, Mission, Philosophy, Vision & Values, but no explicit theology, liturgical practice, or liturgical-community references in the visible text excerpts.

#### Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: 0
- Negative keywords observed: 0
- (No strong classical signals from the page text; no explicit transcendental or liturgical language appears in the crawled content.)

#### Why this rating

- The presence of "Mission/Philosophy/Vision & Values" does not, in itself, establish transcendental moral realism, theology, liturgical practice, or a liturgical communal life as core to the school's program. The classical rubric requires explicit references to truth/goodness/beauty as real per

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transcendentals, or explicit theology or liturgy as foundational, which are not evident in the public crawl text provided. See the positive/negative keyword framework in the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) and related lexicon for the signals that would constitute “CLASSICAL” in this category .

- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site contains Mission/Philosophy/Vision & Values and Curriculum sections, but there is no explicit public articulation of formation over information, virtue/wisdom formation, or a teleological aim centered on truth, goodness, and beauty in the accessible crawl excerpt.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: 0
- Negative keywords observed: 0
- (No explicit “formation” or teleological language present in the crawled text.)

Why this rating

- Classical-category criteria emphasize formation (virtue, wisdom, telos) and a claim that education forms human excellence, not merely information transfer. The public crawl excerpt does not reveal such language or commitments. The Six Essential Elements lexicon treats formation over information and the telos of virtue/wisdom as core signals for CLASSICAL status in this category, which are not evidenced here. See the lexicon and the “Formation” signals in the Six Essential Elements (1) .

- Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The crawl shows a visible navigation item for Curriculum & Instruction, but the accessible text does not reveal Great Books, the trivium/quadrivium, or explicit Great Books/primary-sources engagement. The absence of direct quotes or content about liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) or the Great Books in the accessible excerpt argues against a classical curriculum demonstration in the crawl data.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: 0
- Negative keywords observed: 0
- (No explicit classical-curriculum signals such as Great Books, Trivium, Quadrivium, or “great conversation” in the crawl data.)

Why this rating

- The classical curriculum signals (Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; study of history through a classical lens; ritualized memory and recitation) are not evidenced in the crawl excerpt. The knowledge-base lexicon outlines these elements as core features of a CLASSICAL curriculum; absence of those signals in the site text leads to NOT CLASSICAL in this category .

- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The crawl excerpt does not present explicit pedagogical methods such as Socratic seminars, recitation, chanting, or scholé-based restful learning, which are hallmark signals in the classical pedagogy rubric. The visible items focus on structural navigation rather than teaching methods.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: 0

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- Negative keywords observed: 0
  - (No evidence of “Socratic,” “recitation,” “chanting,” “scholé,” or “rhetoric training” in the crawl text.)

Why this rating

- The Six Essential Elements (Pedagogy) emphasize Socratic discussion in upper grades, and contemplative/restful learning, memory-based recitation, and rhetoric training. The crawl data provides no explicit signals of these methods, which supports a NOT CLASSICAL designation for pedagogy in this school’s publicly visible materials .

• Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The crawl includes standard site sections (About, Governance, Curriculum, etc.) but provides no textual evidence of faculty as living curriculum, mentors, or model-teachers, nor a “portrait of a teacher” or a “faculty as core of the school” narrative in the accessible text.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: 0
- Negative keywords observed: 0
- (No explicit faculty-formation language appears in the crawl text.)

Why this rating

- The classical-faculty signals (model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teacher/student ideals) are not evident in the crawl content. The Six Essential Elements lexicon highlights these signals as essential for CLASSICAL status in the Faculty category; their absence in the public crawl supports NOT CLASSICAL here .

• Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL (with limited signals)

Evidence

- The site includes a Parents section in its navigation, which indicates some level of parental engagement or information for families, but there is no explicit public content in the crawl asserting partnerships with parents as co-teachers or formal parental formation activities. The presence of a “Parents” page is noted, but not the depth of partnership signals described in classical frameworks.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: 0
- Negative keywords observed: 0
- (No explicit “Partnership with Families” or “Parental formation,” which are core signals in the classical community category.)

Why this rating

- Classical models emphasize a robust, explicit partnership with parents (co-teachers, formation of affections in the home, family rhythms, shared mission). The crawl does not present these explicit signals; thus, NOT CLASSICAL in this category. The Six Essential Elements’ Parents & Community signals emphasize partnership with families and parental involvement; those signals are not clearly demonstrated in the crawl data accessible here. .

Aggregate Ranking

- Overall, the six-category assessment yields NOT CLASSICAL.
- Executive interpretation: The accessible public content for Candeo Schools Peoria AZ 85383 highlights general mission/philosophy/values and a Curriculum & Instruction area, but it does not reveal

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the classical signals—Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, scholé, liturgy/theology, or the “living curriculum” faculty model—that the classical rubric requires for a CLASSICAL or SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating. The absence of explicit classical signals across all six categories leads to a NOT CLASSICAL classification when applying the Six Essential Elements framework and the associated keyword indicators .

#### What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here, as the aggregate rating is NOT CLASSICAL. If the school wished to pursue a CLASSICAL alignment, concrete steps would include publicly articulating and integrating:
  - Explicit Great Books and liberal-arts integration (Trivium/Quadrivium) into the curriculum.
  - A classical pedagogy with Socratic discussions, memory work, recitation, and rhetoric training (especially in upper grades).
  - A theology or explicitly faith-integrated, transcendent framework (if aligned with the school’s mission) including liturgical or communal practices.
  - A clearly defined “living curriculum” with faculty modeling virtue and mentorship.
  - Formal partnerships with parents as co-educators with visible programming (book studies, parent workshops, family-liturgy alignment).
- Evidence-based next steps would include updating the About/Philosophy pages to include explicit references to:
  - Great Books and classic texts; temple of memory through recitation; and the Great Conversation.
  - Trivium/Quadrivium and the rationale for their placement in the curriculum.
  - Scholé/restful learning schedules and the role of memory and contemplation in daily structure.
  - Public display of the faculty’s role as mentors and living examples of virtue.
  - A robust Parent-Community section detailing partnerships, parent formation, and on-site parent visits.
- Implementing these would require site-content updates and internal communications to align with the classical framework, followed by re-evaluation under the Six Essential Elements rubric.

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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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